

Did you know...

The global version of Galaxy S5 is powered by Snapdragon 801 processor, while the Indian version employs Exynos

**YouTube banned in Turkey**

After an audio leak of a discussion of possible military operations in Syria, YouTube remains banned in Turkey despite court rulings <http://dgit.in/1hDpIPOn>

Is Windows 8 finally worth the upgrade?

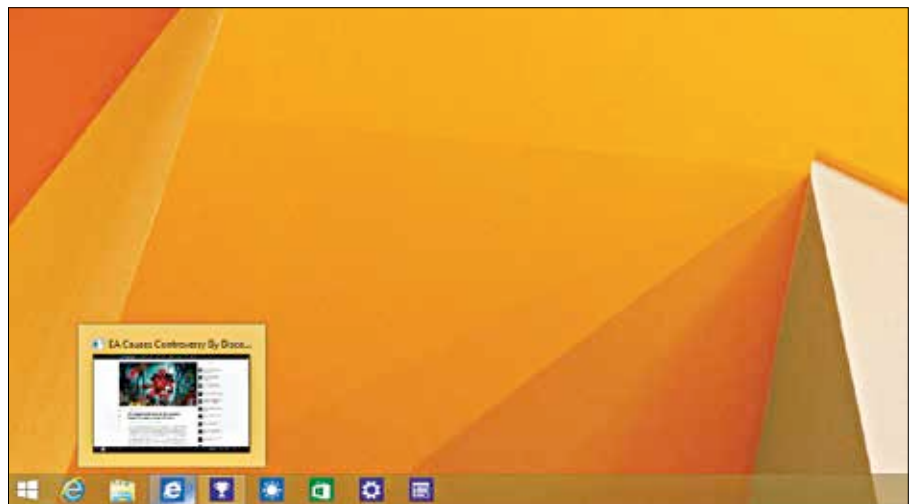
Quick question: What do Windows 8 and Justin Bieber have in common? Well, apart from provoking extreme emotions, both give you the feeling that they haven't quite matured yet

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Windows 7 was great. So great, in fact, that it quickly overtook its predecessor, the venerable Windows XP, to become the most used desktop OS in just two years. It improved on the mistakes of Vista and brought back the stability and reliability of Windows XP – something desktop users recognised and embraced. Things were going great. There were no more Blue Screens of Death, it was more secure and it ran just about anything you threw at it. We take for granted some of its newly introduced features – to the extent that it's impossible to remember a time when they didn't exist. Things such as 'AeroSnap', which would maximise a window simply by dragging it to the top edge of the screen, 'Jump Lists', which allowed you to pin your most used files to the application itself, libraries for organising all of your media and universal search right from within the Start menu are features you don't know you need until you've used them. It was almost too good to last.

Windows 8 shortcomings

Microsoft had been trying to carve off a chunk of the mobile phone market with Windows Phone 7, but the fact that it was struggling was confirmed when it tried to shove the same 'Metro' (later, Modern) UI down our throats in the form of Windows 8. In the days leading up to the Windows 8 release, leaked screenshots and rumours showed what appeared to be a radical departure from the age-old desktop metaphor. Gone was the familiar



Windows 8 apps can now be pinned to the taskbar

Start button and the My Computer and Recycle Bin icons, which were replaced by large, bold and flat icons. The layout suggested a touch-first approach, so it came as no surprise to anyone that desktop users began to feel neglected by a company they'd stood behind for more than a decade.

To start with, the Windows 8 setup required you to sign in using a Microsoft/Outlook/Hotmail account. Having your sacred PC forcefully tied to a cloud account (one that most of us had forgotten



A handy notification informs you of newly installed apps instead of auto-adding them to the Start menu

about, to be honest) wasn't seen as a friendly move. On signing in, you were greeted by brightly coloured tiles, most of which accomplished nothing a browser couldn't do. 'Apps' to check your mail, read the news, check the weather or look up directions on a map were redundant – these were things a Google search could do just as well, if not better. If you finally made it past the mess of a Start screen (Just WHY a desktop user would want horizontal scrolling is beyond us) and got to the 'traditional' desktop, you'd be in for a mild shock. The Start button in the bottom-left corner is missing – a signature feature of Windows that had been a comforting presence since the days of Windows 95. Clicking on what should have been the Start button (or the Windows key, for power users) would lead you back to the Start screen. If you thought this was your only hurdle, good luck trying to do something as basic as shutting down or restarting your PC. We were embarrassed